



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 12

PART 1

You will hear a woman booking a community cooking class over the phone. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker A: Hello, is this the Community Arts and Culinary Centre?

Speaker B: Yes, it is! My name is Mark. How can I help you today?

Speaker A: Hi, Mark. I'm Sarah, and I'd like to book a spot in one of your upcoming cooking classes. I saw a flyer at the local library.

Speaker B: Great! We have a few different classes starting soon. Which one were you interested in?

Speaker A: I'm looking at the vegetarian cooking class. I've been trying to eat healthier lately.

Speaker B: Excellent choice. Let me just get your details down first. Can I have your full name, please?

Speaker A: Yes, it's Sarah Harrison. That's H-A-R-R-I-S-O-N.

Speaker B: Got it. And a contact phone number?

Speaker A: Sure, it's 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2.

Speaker B: Let me repeat that back: 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2. Is that correct?

Speaker A: Yes, that's it.

Speaker B: Perfect. Now, regarding the vegetarian cooking class, we have a session coming up. It starts on Friday the 12th of November... oh, wait, sorry, let me check that calendar again. Friday is indeed the 12th, but that class is actually on Saturday the 13th of November. My apologies.

Speaker A: Oh, Saturday the 13th is actually much better for me anyway. What time does it start?

Speaker B: It runs from 10:30 am to 1:00 pm.

Speaker A: That's perfect. Where exactly is the class held?

Speaker B: It takes place in our main Community Centre kitchen, on the ground floor.

Speaker A: Excellent. And is there parking nearby?

Speaker B: Yes, there is a small parking lot right behind the library, which is just a short walk from us. It's free on Saturdays.

Speaker A: That's very convenient. Do I need to bring anything with me?

Speaker B: We provide all the ingredients and cooking utensils, but we do ask all participants to bring their own apron to keep their clothes clean.

Speaker A: I can definitely do that. How much is the class, and do I need to pay a deposit?

Speaker B: The total price is 40 pounds, and we require a deposit of 15 pounds to secure your spot. You can pay the rest on the day.

Speaker A: That sounds reasonable. I'll pay the deposit by card over the phone now.

Speaker B: Great. I'll process that now. Okay, the payment went through. I'll generate a booking reference for you. Your reference number is 8-2-4-1-9-5... wait, I need to correct that, I read the wrong line on my screen. The reference code is actually 8-2-1-4-9-5.

Speaker A: Let me write that down: 8-2-1-4-9-5. Got it.

Speaker B: Excellent. You'll receive a confirmation email shortly. We look forward to seeing you on the 13th!

Speaker A: Thank you. What kind of dishes will we be making in the vegetarian class?

Speaker B: We'll be focusing on seasonal vegetables. You'll learn how to make a hearty vegetable curry from scratch, and also a warm quinoa salad with roasted squash and beetroot.

Speaker A: That sounds absolutely delicious. I've always wanted to learn how to make a proper curry paste.

Speaker B: It's a fantastic skill to have, and it tastes so much better than the store-bought jars. Thank you so much for your help, Sarah. Have a great day!

Speaker A: You too, Mark. Bye!

This is the end of Part 1.

PART 2

You will hear a coordinator talking about a local community garden project. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone. It's wonderful to see so many familiar and new faces here tonight. My name is Michael, and I am the coordinator for the Oakridge Community Garden. I want to start by sharing a bit of our history. Many people assume the garden was initiated by the local council as part of a green spaces campaign, or perhaps that it grew out of a school biology project. In fact, it was actually sparked by a simple neighborhood cleanup event. A group of residents gathered to clear a vacant, neglected lot of rubbish, and we realized the space had immense potential to become something beautiful and productive. That was five years ago, and look at us now!

Speaker A: People often ask me about our opening hours. While we would love to keep the gates open all the time, we have to balance this with security and maintenance. Currently, the garden is open to the general public every day of the week, from 8:00 am until 6:00 pm. In our first year, we tried opening on weekends only, and then later we tried weekdays and Saturday mornings, but we found that daily access is much more beneficial for the local community, especially for retirees and parents with young children who visit during weekdays.

Speaker A: Now, sustainability is at the heart of everything we do here. One of our biggest challenges initially was irrigation, as watering a garden of this size can consume a lot of water. We don't rely on the local council to supply our water, nor do we draw from the nearby stream, as we want to preserve the local natural habitats. Instead, we have successfully installed an extensive rainwater harvest system. We collect water from the roofs of all our sheds and structures into large tanks, which provides more than enough water for our needs, even during dry summer spells.

Speaker A: If you are thinking of volunteering with us, please don't let a lack of experience hold you back. We often hear from people who are worried they don't know enough about plants. We don't require you to attend a mandatory training course before you begin, nor do we relegate inexperienced volunteers to boring administrative tasks. Instead, we pair you up with an experienced mentor. You will work alongside them, learning practical skills like pruning, composting, and planting in a supportive, hands-on environment.

Speaker A: We also have some rules to ensure the garden remains a pleasant space for everyone. The most important one concerns harvesting. We want everyone to enjoy the fruits of our labor, but we must prevent people from taking too much. We don't charge a fee for the vegetables you take, and we don't restrict harvesting solely to garden

coordinators. However, we ask that you follow one strict rule: only harvest what you will eat that day. This ensures there is always enough left for other members of the community.

Speaker A: Looking ahead, we have some very exciting projects on the horizon. Next month, we plan to construct a new greenhouse. This will allow us to start seeds earlier in the year and grow more exotic, heat-loving plants like peppers and tomatoes. Additionally, to encourage local wildlife and increase biodiversity, volunteers will build a special pond. This will provide a habitat for frogs, dragonflies, and various beneficial insects.

Speaker A: Of course, these developments require funding. We are incredibly grateful to have received a generous grant recently from a local bank, which will cover the material costs for our upcoming builds.

Speaker A: We also love to celebrate our community. Our upcoming Autumn Festival is just around the corner, and it's going to be a fantastic day. The highlight of the festival will be a cooking competition, where participants will use ingredients grown right here in the garden to create delicious dishes.

Speaker A: If you want to keep up to date with our events, volunteer schedules, or if you'd like to sign up for our monthly newsletter, please visit our website. We update it weekly with all the latest garden news. Thank you all for listening, and I hope to see you in the garden soon.

This is the end of Part 2.

PART 3

You will hear two university students, Helen and Clara, discussing their research project on urban foxes. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Hi, Clara. I'm so glad we finally have some time to sit down and discuss our research project. The deadline is in three weeks, so we really need to finalize our report on urban foxes.

Speaker B: Absolutely, Helen. I've been reviewing our notes. To start with, let's think about our introduction. We need to explain why we chose urban foxes in the first place.

Speaker A: Right. Some people might think we did it because our tutor, Dr. Jenkins, pushed us into it, but she actually gave us complete freedom. And while there is some local data available, it's pretty outdated and disorganized.

Speaker B: Exactly. The main reason was that we wanted to investigate a common misconception. Most people believe urban foxes are a nuisance and purely scavengers, but our initial readings suggested they actually play a complex role in the urban ecosystem. We wanted to see if that was true in our study area.

Speaker A: Yes, that was a great starting point. And our fieldwork really opened my eyes. I was particularly surprised by their diet.

Speaker B: Me too. I thought we would find that they survive almost entirely on food provided by well-meaning residents, or by raiding rubbish bins.

Speaker A: Yes, or that they hunted small rodents like mice and rats constantly. But when we analyzed the fecal samples and observed them, they actually eat a significant amount of fruit, especially during the autumn when berries are abundant. It makes up a huge portion of their diet.

Speaker B: It's fascinating how adaptable they are. Now, let's talk about our methodology. How did we collect most of our data?

Speaker A: Well, we initially thought about distributing online questionnaires to residents, but we realized the response rate might be too low or biased.

Speaker B: And interviewing park rangers was helpful for background context, but they couldn't give us the specific behavioral data we needed.

Speaker A: So, setting up motion-activated cameras in the nature reserve and local gardens was definitely the best decision. We got hours of high-quality footage of their nighttime activities.



Speaker B: It was brilliant, but analyzing that footage was a massive task! What did you find most challenging about the data analysis phase?

Speaker A: For me, it was definitely categorizing the blurry nighttime photos. Sometimes it was just a tail or a shadow, and we had to decide if it was a fox, a cat, or just a branch moving in the wind.

Speaker B: Really? I actually found using the specialized statistical software to map their movements much harder. It took me days to figure out how to input the GPS coordinates correctly.

Speaker A: Oh, I see. Well, at least we managed to get it done in the end. So, what do we hope this report will achieve?

Speaker B: It would be amazing if it could change local policy on wildlife management, but that's probably too ambitious for an undergraduate project.

Speaker A: True. And while securing funding for a larger regional study would be nice, our main goal is to educate the public about coexisting with foxes. We want to show people that they aren't pests, but rather a natural part of the city.

Speaker B: I agree. Now, let's divide up the remaining tasks so we can get this written up. We need to decide who does what.

Speaker A: Okay. Well, we should definitely write the introduction together. It sets the tone for the whole paper, so it makes sense for both of us to contribute.

Speaker B: I agree. What about the maps and charts? I've already spent so much time with the statistical software, so I don't mind taking charge of creating those visual elements.

Speaker A: That would be wonderful, Clara. In that case, I can focus on reviewing the academic literature. I've already compiled a list of relevant journals, so I can summarize the existing research.

Speaker B: Perfect. I can also handle formatting the bibliography. I'm quite familiar with the Harvard referencing style, so I can make sure everything is consistent.

Speaker A: Thanks, Clara. That leaves the oral presentation. We both have to speak during the seminar, so we should prepare the slides and practice the presentation together.

Speaker B: Definitely. Let's schedule a study session for that next Tuesday.

Speaker A: Sounds like a plan. Let's get started on the drafting!

This is the end of Part 3.

PART 4

You will hear a lecture about the history of paper and its impact on human civilization. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Welcome back to our lectures on the history of technology. Today, we will explore a material so common that we often take it for granted: paper. To understand its revolutionary impact, we must first look at what came before it.

Speaker A: In the ancient world, writing was a labor-intensive process. The earliest writing materials included clay tablets, used in Mesopotamia. While they were incredibly durable, they were heavy and difficult to transport over long distances. In ancient Egypt, papyrus became the dominant medium. Made from the pith of the papyrus reed, it was lightweight and relatively easy to write on. However, papyrus had a major drawback: it was highly sensitive to moisture. In humid climates, it would rot, and in very dry conditions, it became brittle and crumbled.

Speaker A: Another alternative was parchment, which was developed in Europe and the Mediterranean. Made from processed animal skins, parchment was highly durable and could be folded into books. However, it was extremely expensive to produce, requiring the skins of dozens of animals for a single volume. This meant that literacy and book ownership remained privileges of the wealthy elite.

Speaker A: The true revolution began in China during the Han Dynasty, around the year 105 AD. A court official named Cai Lun is traditionally credited with inventing paper as we know it. He developed a process of pulping materials such as hemp, rags, and, crucially, mulberry bark. By mixing these fibers with water, pressing them flat, and drying them, he created a smooth, flexible writing surface.

Speaker A: The main advantage of this new paper was its light weight, which made it far easier to carry than clay or wood, and it was significantly cheaper to produce than parchment. This combination of affordability and portability allowed information to be recorded and shared on an unprecedented scale.

Speaker A: For centuries, the Chinese kept the art of paper-making a closely guarded secret. However, in the 8th century, the technology began to spread westward. Following the Battle of Talas in 751 AD, Chinese papermakers were captured, and the knowledge reached the Islamic world. The first paper mills were established in Baghdad, which quickly became a center of scholarship and translation.

Speaker A: From the Islamic world, paper-making technology gradually entered Europe. By the 11th century, the first European paper mills were active in Spain and Sicily, and the technology soon spread throughout the continent, paving the way for the invention of the

printing press in the 15th century.

Speaker A: The industrial era of the 19th century brought further massive changes. The invention of the steam-driven paper machine dramatically increased the speed of production. No longer made by hand sheet by sheet, paper could now be produced in continuous rolls. To meet the soaring demand, manufacturers needed a cheaper and more abundant raw material than cotton or linen rags. They found the solution in wood pulp. This transition made paper incredibly cheap, leading to the rise of daily newspapers and affordable novels.

Speaker A: However, the mass production of paper has not been without its downsides. In the 20th century, environmental concerns began to emerge. The chemicals used in bleaching paper to make it bright white caused significant water pollution in rivers near mills. In response, modern industries have adopted cleaner processes and recycling programs. Recycling not only saves energy but also helps to conserve valuable forests.

Speaker A: Today, despite the rise of digital screens, paper remains an essential part of our lives. Beyond books and documents, paper is crucial for global trade, particularly in the form of cardboard packaging for shipping goods. It is clear that paper has shaped, and continues to shape, the course of human history.

This is the end of Part 4.

